

PARAPHRASE OF TELEGRAM RECEIVED

FROM: AMERICAN LEGATION, BERN.
TO: Secretary of State, Washington
DATE: January 30, 1944
NUMBER: 619

(1) We personally delivered to Riegner on January 25, pursuant to a letter dated January 22nd, text of license numbered W-2115, contained in Department's 197, January 20, and revoked the license issued pursuant to Department's 3168.

(2) (Refers to inadvertent omissions which have been disposed of by the Code Room.)

(3) Riegner advises that the best method of acquiring French currency may well be as follows: Refugees now in Switzerland have funds hidden in France which could be transferred to the Jewish underground, provided Riegner purchased such francs from these refugees here. Riegner requests confirmation that this transaction would fall within the authorization contained in paragraph One (a) of the new license, before undertaking any such purchases.

(4) The WJC agent in France has been authorized by Riegner to purchase in France the local currency equivalent of Swiss francs 25,000. The Swiss francs are blocked in Switzerland. Riegner advises that he instructed his agent to pay a small premium because of the necessity of blocking the Swiss francs. The rate currently obtaining for bills in Switzerland is 1.67 to 1.80 Swiss francs for each 100 French francs. The premium which Riegner has authorized his agent to offer brings it up to slightly above two Swiss francs for each 100 French francs.

HARRISON

EH:WIR:AMN 1/31/44

CC - Messrs. Pehle, Luxford, DuBois, Schmidt, Fox, O'Flaherty

Miss Hodel